

Impersonation of Northern Ireland brands, institutions and public services

Scope: 71 Northern Ireland entities — NI-serving banks, utilities, public services, health, transport, industry, media, sport and education, plus NI-only service vocabulary · **Window:** 1 January – 6 August 2026 (year to date) · **Liveness:** direct probe, 6 August 2026 · **Method:** rendered page content; no domain-token or permutation logic

11

CONFIRMED FINDINGS

5

HIGH SEVERITY

5

STILL HOSTING

4

NO BRAND TOKEN

71

ENTITIES SCOPED

Bottom line

Three sweeps across 71 Northern Ireland entities and NI-only service vocabulary confirm **11 impersonating domains** year to date, of which **5 are high severity**. **5 were still hosting** when probed on 6 August 2026.

The number is small, and understanding why is the point of this report. Northern Ireland has roughly 1.9 million residents. Commodity phishing operators work on volume economics, and an NI-only brand — Power NI, Translink, nidirect, the Housing Executive — simply does not have a large enough customer base to justify a dedicated kit. NI residents are targeted heavily, but through *UK-wide* brands: HMRC, DVLA, Royal Mail, the large banks. Those campaigns are real and they land in Belfast exactly as they land in Birmingham — they are just not Northern Irish campaigns, and they do not appear in an NI-scoped hunt.

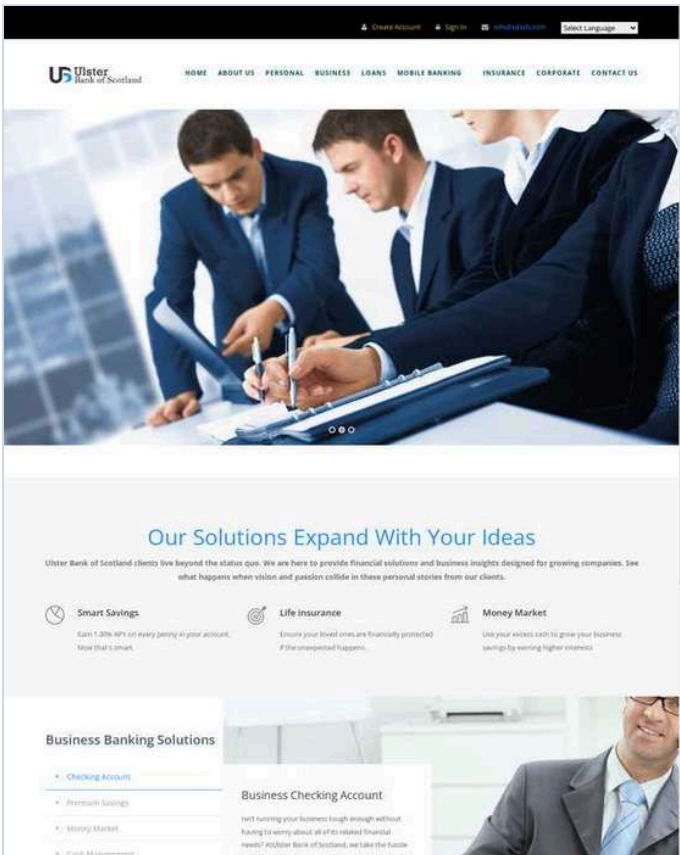
What did surface splits cleanly into three groups:

- **Banks that serve NI** — the only sector with genuine credential-capture pages. All five are all-island or GB institutions with NI operations rather than NI-only brands.
- **NI-native digital platforms** — PropertyPal, the province's dominant property portal, is the one genuinely local brand being cloned.
- **NI employers and place names** — Kainos, and the use of "Belfast" itself as a credibility device.

Zero findings against the entire NI public-service estate. Precise queries returned nothing for Translink, Power NI, NI Water, the Housing Executive, PSNI, nidirect, Education Authority, Invest NI, Tourism NI, the HSC trusts, or any of the eleven district councils. Danske Bank — the largest retail bank in Northern Ireland — returned **zero** impersonations once Danish-language noise was excluded. For a defender that is genuinely good news, and it is worth stating as a finding rather than omitting because it is a null result.

1 — Banks serving Northern Ireland

5 findings, and the only category in this report producing genuine credential pages. Note what these institutions have in common: each is an all-island or GB bank with a Northern Ireland operation, not an NI-only brand. The customer base that makes a kit worth building extends well beyond the province.

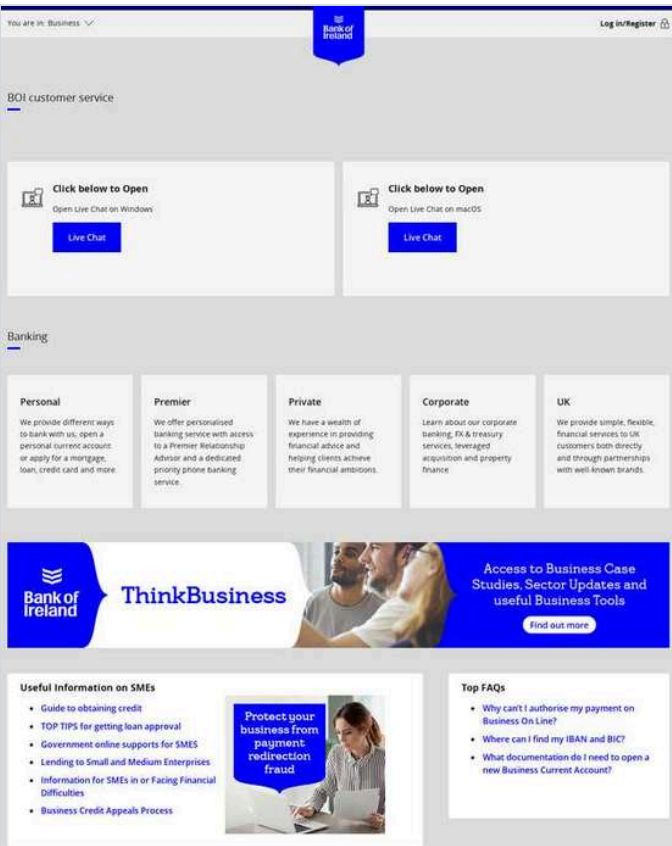


ubofs.com HIGH LIVE

Ulster Bank of Scotland - Personal, Mortgage and Small Business

? · age unknown · 142.251.29.95

Renders 'Ulster Bank of Scotland - Personal, Mortgage and Small Business'. No such institution exists - the name fuses Ulster Bank with Bank of Scotland to manufacture familiarity. The most-scanned NI finding in the window



business-online-ie.com **HIGH** **OFFLINE**

Business Banking | Bank of Ireland

2026-06-16 · 51d online · 104.21.75.107

Renders 'Business Banking | Bank of Ireland'. Targets business rather than retail customers, where single transaction values are materially higher.

The most interesting finding in the report is an institution that does not exist. ubofs.com renders "*Ulster Bank of Scotland — Personal, Mortgage and Small Business*". There is no such bank. The name fuses **Ulster Bank** with **Bank of Scotland** — two real, separately recognisable institutions — to manufacture familiarity without impersonating either precisely enough to trip a brand-exact watchlist. It was also the most-scanned NI finding in the window.

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Bank of Ireland is regulated by the Central Bank of Ireland. Bank of Ireland trading in The Mortgage Market, governed by Bank of Ireland is regulated by the Central Bank of Ireland. Bank of Ireland (UK) plc is

reviewboi-attempts.com **HIGH** **RESOLVING**

Login - Bank of Ireland

2026-06-11 · 56d online · 104.18.40.68

Renders 'Login - Bank of Ireland'. The domain pairs the BOI initialism with a security-review pretext, which is the standard framing for a credential page.

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Bank of Ireland is regulated by the Central Bank of Ireland. Bank of Ireland trading in The Mortgage Market, governed by Bank of Ireland is regulated by the Central Bank of Ireland. Bank of Ireland (UK) plc is

365secure-alerts.com **HIGH** **OFFLINE**

Login - Bank of Ireland

2026-06-04 · 63d online · 104.17.24.14

Renders 'Login - Bank of Ireland'. Uses the '365' platform name with a security-alert pretext. Note the bank's genuine platform is 365online.com, which is excluded here.

Two domains render **Bank of Ireland** login pages. reviewboi-attempts.com pairs the BOI initialism with a security-review pretext; 365secure-alerts.com uses the bank's **365** platform name with a security-alert framing.

A necessary exclusion. Bank of Ireland's genuine online banking platform is 365online.com. It appears in the raw sweep and has been removed. Any detection built on the "365" string must allow-list the real platform first — the wider "365 online" phrase is one of the noisiest on the internet.

Domain	Tier	Entity	Sector	Rendered title	Server IP	Token	Registered	Status
ubofs.com	HIGH	Ulster Bank	Banking	Ulster Bank of Scotland - Personal	142.251.29.95	no token	-	LIVE
365secure-alerts.com	HIGH	Bank of Ireland	Banking	Login - Bank of Ireland	104.17.24.14	no token	2026-06-04	OFFLINE
reviewboi-attempts.com	HIGH	Bank of Ireland	Banking	Login - Bank of Ireland	104.18.40.68	token	2026-06-11	RESOLVING
business-online-ie.com	HIGH	Bank of Ireland	Banking	Business Banking Bank of Ireland	104.21.75.107	no token	2026-06-16	OFFLINE
progressive-democratio.com	MEDIUM	Progressive Building Society	Banking	Progressive Building Society	185.158.133.1	token	2026-04-09	RESOLVING

2 — PropertyPal, the one NI-native platform being cloned

PropertyPal is Northern Ireland’s dominant property portal and effectively the default starting point for anyone buying or renting in the province. It is the only genuinely NI-native digital brand in this report attracting sustained impersonation.

Base 44

Your app is waiting to shine!

But it isn't live yet.
Publish it to make it visible here.

property-pal.net

HIGHLIVE

PropertyPal (Copy)
2026-07-30 · 7d online · 192.178.223.84

Renders 'PropertyPal (Copy)' - the parenthetical is the site builder's own artefact, indicating a cloned template. PropertyPal is Northern Ireland's dominant property portal.

PropertyPal

PropertiesHow It WorksAboutContact

Sign inBook a Viewing

Smart Property Appointments

Streamline your property viewings with our elite AI scheduling system. Book instantly and manage everything from one secure dashboard.

Browse Properties

Get Started

5 Star Rating

Over 2,000+ Happy Renters

Next Viewing Tomorrow, 2 PM

RM 4,500/mo

Verified Owner

Luxury Multi-Gabled House

Bukit Tunku Kuala Lumpur

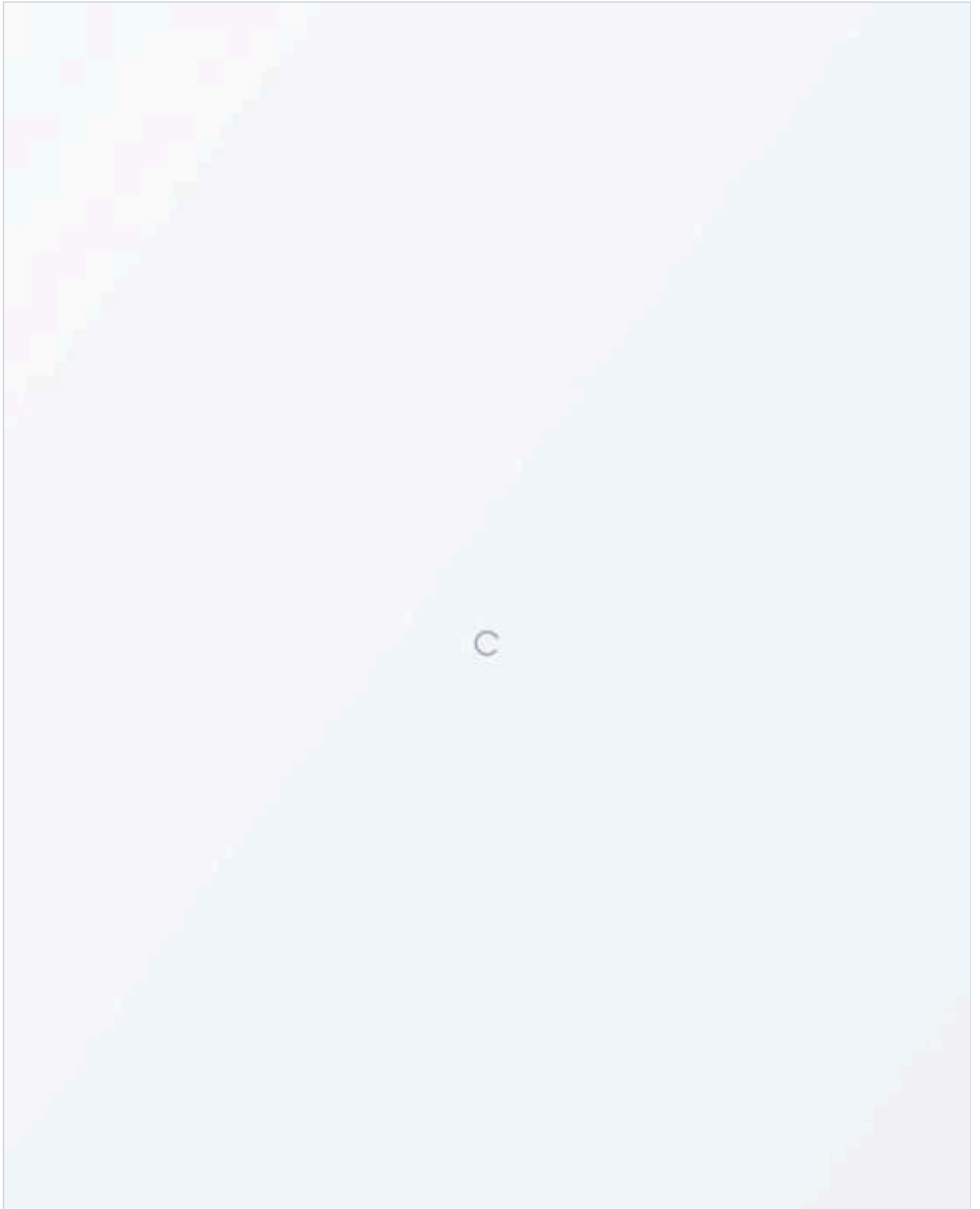
propertypals.org

MEDIUMLIVE

PropertyPal
2026-06-14 · 53d online · 216.198.79.65

Renders 'PropertyPal' on a pluralised domain. Classic single-character brand variant.

property-pal.net renders "PropertyPal (Copy)". That parenthetical is not part of the real brand — it is an artefact left by the site builder used to duplicate the template, and it is a useful reminder that operators frequently ship without cleaning up.



property-helper.info MEDIUM OFFLINE

PropertyPal

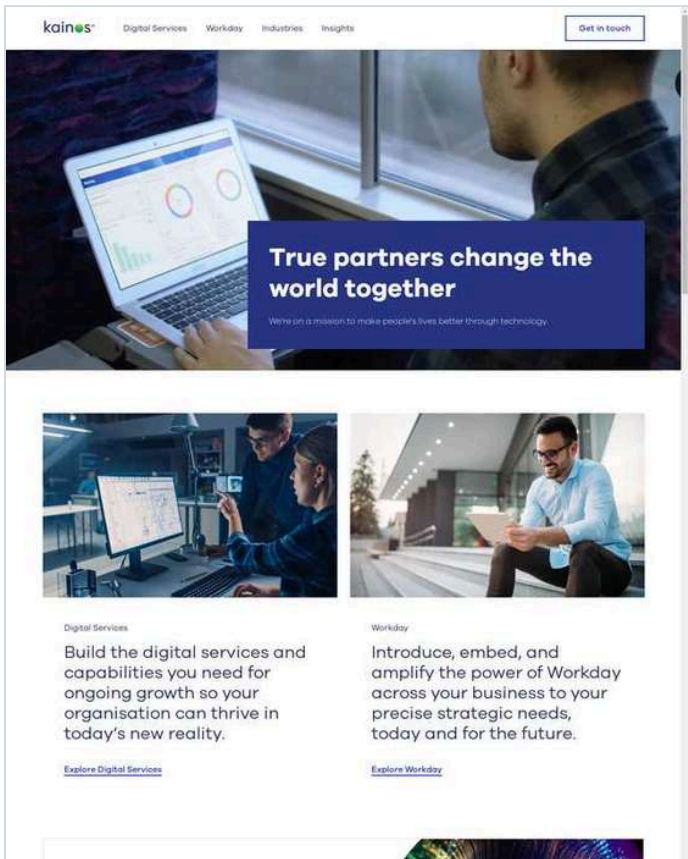
2026-02-08 · 179d online · 216.24.57.1

Renders 'PropertyPal' from a domain carrying no brand token at all - it would not appear in any watchlist seeded on the brand name.

The no-token case. property-helper.info renders PropertyPal branding from a domain containing no form of the brand name whatsoever. A watchlist seeded on "propertypal" and its permutations would never generate it. It was found because the rendered page carries the brand, which is the entire argument for content-based detection.

Domain	Tier	Entity	Sector	Rendered title	Server IP	Token	Registered	Status
property-pal.net	HIGH	PropertyPal	Property	PropertyPal (Copy)	192.178.223.84	token	2026-07-30	LIVE
propertypals.org	MEDIUM	PropertyPal	Property	PropertyPal	216.198.79.65	token	2026-06-14	LIVE
property-helper.info	MEDIUM	PropertyPal	Property	PropertyPal	216.24.57.1	no token	2026-02-08	OFFLINE

3 — NI employers and the use of place

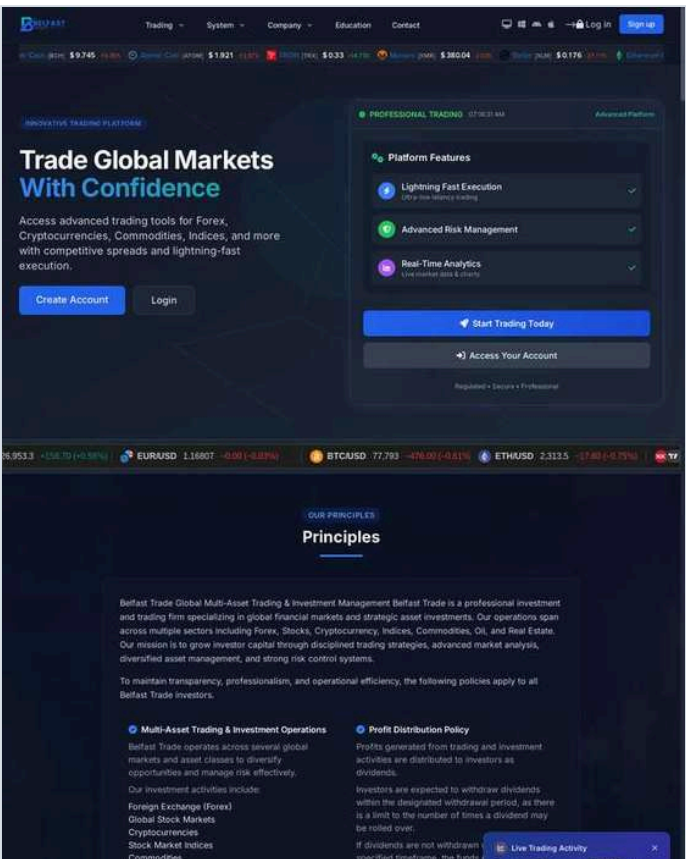


kainosppc.com **MEDIUM** **LIVE**

Digital Transformation Experts and Workday Partners | Kainos

2026-07-24 · 13d online · 151.101.194.217

Renders 'Digital Transformation Experts and Workday Partners | Kainos'. Kainos is a Belfast-headquartered FTSE-listed software firm. Registered as a pair with kainosppc.net.



belfasttrade.live **MEDIUM** **CHANGED**

Belfast Trade | CFD Trading — Trading on Stocks, Gold, Oil, Indi ? · age unknown · 84.17.50.24

Renders 'Belfast Trade | CFD Trading - Trading on Stocks, Gold, Oil'. Uses the city name to manufacture local credibility for a contracts-for-difference offering. No NI brand is impersonated; the place name is doing the work.

Kainos is a Belfast-headquartered, FTSE-listed software firm and one of Northern Ireland's largest technology employers. **kainosppc.com** and **kainosppc.net** render its positioning verbatim and were registered **a day apart** — a deliberate two-domain acquisition, not an isolated registration. Brand abuse against a listed employer creates exposure on two fronts at once: candidate-facing recruitment fraud and client-facing procurement fraud.

belfasttrade.live is a different mechanism entirely. It impersonates no NI brand at all — it renders "**Belfast Trade | CFD Trading**" and uses the **city name itself** to manufacture local credibility for a contracts-for-difference offering. Place-anchored financial lures are worth watching in any region with a strong local identity, and they are invisible to brand monitoring by construction.

Domain	Tier	Entity	Sector	Rendered title	Server IP	Token	Registered	Status
kainosppc.com	MEDIUM	Kainos	Technology	Digital Transformation Experts and	151.101.194.217	token	2026-07-24	LIVE
kainosppc.net	MEDIUM	Kainos	Technology	Digital Transformation Experts and	130.248.246.42	token	2026-07-25	LIVE
belfasttrade.live	MEDIUM	Belfast (place)	Investment	Belfast Trade CFD Trading — Trad	84.17.50.24	token	-	CHANGED

4 — Why Northern Ireland is unusually hard to monitor

This is the most transferable finding in the report. Northern Ireland brand names collide with other languages and markets more severely than any region we have assessed. A watchlist built from NI brand names without qualification does not merely produce noise — it produces almost nothing else.

NI term	What it actually returned	Why
Danske Danske Bank	Danish casino comparison sites and adult-content directories, dozens of them	"Danske" is simply Danish for "Danish". The bank's name means "Danish Bank". Every Danish-language site describing anything as Danish matches.
SPAR Henderson Group	Danish and German discount retailers, deal aggregators	"Spar" means "save" in Danish, German and Dutch. Any promotion saying "save 20%" matches.
HSC Health and Social Care NI	Australian tutoring, exam-prep and AI essay-grading platforms	HSC is the Higher School Certificate in New South Wales. It dominates the string globally.
AIB	A Polish plumbing wholesaler, an Australian business school, Afghanistan International Bank, a Montreal AI consultancy	Three-letter initialisms are shared across every market on earth.
DVA Driver & Vehicle Agency	Czech garages and marketing agencies, Australian community nursing	"Dva" is Czech for "two" , and DVA is also Australia's Department of Veterans' Affairs.
Stormont	A township in Ontario, a Canadian sea cadet corps, Ontario property listings	Stormont is a place name in Canada as well as the seat of the NI Assembly.
QUB	A Québécois online bookshop	QUB livre — unrelated French-language commerce.
Ulster	A bank, a university, a rugby team, and three counties of the Republic of Ireland	Ulster is a province spanning the border; the term is not NI-specific at all.
LPS Land & Property Services	Vinyl record shops, US and Australian land-services firms, insurance rate comparison	"LPs" are records; "rates online" is insurance marketing.
Belfast	Several hundred entirely legitimate local businesses — kitchen fitters, dentists, roofers, hairdressers, web designers	A city name qualified only by "login" or "account" returns the local economy, not threats.
Nightline	A US AI receptionist service, a clothing brand, a tactical shooter, a lo-fi music channel	The NI parcel carrier shares its name with several unrelated products.
"Top up" keypad electricity	Indonesian game-credit sites, in volume	Game top-up is a vastly larger global market than NI keypad meters.

Every one of those was in our candidate set before removal. The first sweep returned 126 domains and the second 216; after reading them, **11 survived**. We are not presenting that ratio as a weakness — it is the measurement. An NI brand-monitoring programme that does not control for this will spend its entire budget triaging Danish casinos and Australian exam tutoring.

What actually works for NI

1. **Match rendered content, not the brand string.** Every finding here was confirmed by reading the page.
2. **Qualify every short or dictionary-word brand.** Danske needs a Danish-language exclusion; hsc needs Australian education terms excluded; u1ster needs the specific institution named.

3. **Use NI-only service vocabulary as the anchor** — rate bill, keypad electricity, DVA test centre, nidirect, Housing Executive. These have no meaningful non-NI usage. That they returned nothing this window is a genuine null result, not a failed query.

5 — Detection quality

4/11 NO BRAND TOKEN	9/9 SEEN WITHIN 7 DAYS OF REGISTRATION	12 MEDIAN DAYS ONLINE	53 LONGEST ONLINE
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4 of 11 findings carry no form of the brand name in the domain. `property-helper.info` renders PropertyPal; `ubofs.com` renders a bank that does not exist; `business-online-ie.com` renders Bank of Ireland business banking. None would be generated by a permutation engine seeded on the brand.

Where domain-derived detection does work here, and it should be credited. `propertypals.org`, `property-pal.net`, `kainosppc.com` and `kainosppc.net` all carry the brand and a competent permutation list would catch them. The argument is not that domain monitoring is useless — it is that in this dataset it covers roughly two thirds of findings, and the third it misses includes the single most sophisticated one.

6 — Recommendations

- **Do not build an NI programme on brand strings alone.** The collision table above is the reason. Content matching plus per-brand language exclusions is the minimum viable approach.
- **Prioritise the banks and PropertyPal.** They are the only NI-facing brands with confirmed credential or clone activity year to date.
- **Allow-list genuine platform domains before deploying anything.** `365online.com` is Bank of Ireland's own service and will otherwise be flagged on every run.
- **Keep the NI-only vocabulary monitors running despite the null result.** Rate bills, keypad top-ups, DVA MOT booking and nidirect are the highest-consequence NI pretexts if they ever appear. Zero today is a baseline, not a reason to stop looking.
- **Watch place-anchored lures separately from brand abuse.** `belfasttrade.live` impersonates nothing — it borrows the city. No brand-monitoring product will surface that class.
- **Read this alongside UK-wide monitoring.** NI residents are targeted primarily through HMRC, DVLA, Royal Mail and the large banks. Those campaigns are out of scope here by definition and are where the actual consumer harm in Northern Ireland is concentrated.

Annex — all findings

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365secure-alerts.com	HIGH	Bank of Ireland	Banking	Login - Bank of Ireland	104.17.24.14	no token	2026-06-04	OFFLINE
reviewboi-attempts.com	HIGH	Bank of Ireland	Banking	Login - Bank of Ireland	104.18.40.68	token	2026-06-11	RESOLVING
business-online-ie.com	HIGH	Bank of Ireland	Banking	Business Banking Bank of Ireland	104.21.75.107	no token	2026-06-16	OFFLINE
propertypals.org	MEDIUM	PropertyPal	Property	PropertyPal	216.198.79.65	token	2026-06-14	LIVE
kainosppc.com	MEDIUM	Kainos	Technology	Digital Transformation Experts and	151.101.194.217	token	2026-07-24	LIVE
kainosppc.net	MEDIUM	Kainos	Technology	Digital Transformation Experts and	130.248.246.42	token	2026-07-25	LIVE
property-helper.info	MEDIUM	PropertyPal	Property	PropertyPal	216.24.57.1	no token	2026-02-08	OFFLINE
progressive-demo.com	MEDIUM	Progressive Building Society	Banking	Progressive Building Society	185.158.133.1	token	2026-04-09	RESOLVING
belfasttrade.live	MEDIUM	Belfast (place)	Investment	Belfast Trade CFD Trading — Trad	84.17.50.24	token	-	CHANGED

Assessment notes

Domain	Assessment
365secure-alerts.com	Renders 'Login - Bank of Ireland'. Uses the '365' platform name with a security-alert pretext. Note the bank's genuine platform is 365online.com, which is excluded here.
business-online-ie.com	Renders 'Business Banking Bank of Ireland'. Targets business rather than retail customers, where single transaction values are materially higher.
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kainosppc.com	Renders 'Digital Transformation Experts and Workday Partners Kainos'. Kainos is a Belfast-headquartered FTSE-listed software firm. Registered as a pair with kainosppc.net.
kainosppc.net	Identical rendering to kainosppc.com and registered a day apart - a deliberate two-domain acquisition rather than an isolated registration.
progressive-demo.com	Renders 'Progressive Building Society', Northern Ireland's largest building society. The '-demo' construction suggests a staged or test deployment rather than a live lure.
property-helper.info	Renders 'PropertyPal' from a domain carrying no brand token at all - it would not appear in any watchlist seeded on the brand name.
propertypals.org	Renders 'PropertyPal' on a pluralised domain. Classic single-character brand variant.

Webamon regional threat assessment. Findings derive from rendered page content observed between 1 January and 6 August 2026; liveness was established by direct DNS and HTTP probe on 6 August 2026. Screenshots are reproduced from the scan that captured each page. Every finding was verified by reading its rendered page. No finding derives from domain-string, permutation or certificate matching. Counts reflect the visibility of this corpus and the NI-scoped entity list; UK-wide campaigns that affect Northern Ireland residents are out of scope by construction and are not represented here.